1. Aim:

Triage refers to the evaluation and categorization of the sick or wounded when there are insufficient resources for medical care of everyone at once. Triage is used in a number of situations in hospital, including:

- In **mass casualty** situations, triage is used to decide who is most urgently in need of transportation to ICU (generally, those who have a chance of survival but who would die without immediate treatment),whose injuries are less severe and to determine which patients should be seen and treated immediately.

- Triage may be used to prioritize the use of space or equipment, such as operating rooms, in a crowded medical facility.

2. Rationale:

To save the lives of the people and avoid medical complications of the patients received In a disaster or mass casualty situation.

3. Various personnel responsible

- Casualty Medical officer
- RMO In-charge
- Nurses

4. Procedure

- In a disaster or mass casualty situation, immediately after receiving the patients , the first step is to check the vital signs of the patients i.e. heart rate, respiration and blood pressure in order to identify seriously ill persons who must receive immediate care.
- The victims are grouped into four categories, depending on the urgency of their needs, it involves a color-coding scheme using red, yellow, green,

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white, and black tags:

4.2.1Red tags - (immediate) are used to label those who cannot survive without immediate treatment but who have a chance of survival.

- **4.2.2Yellow tags** - (observation) for those who require observation (and possible later re-triage). Their condition is stable for the moment and, they are not in immediate danger of death. These victims will still need hospital care and would be treated immediately under normal circumstances.

- **4.2.3Green tags** - (wait) are reserved for the "walking wounded" who will need medical care at some point, after more critical injuries have been treated.

- **4.2.4White tags** - (dismiss) are given to those with minor injuries for whom a doctor's care is not required.

- **4.2.5Black tags** - (expectant) are used for the deceased and for those whose injuries are so extensive that they will not be able to survive given the care that is available.

1. The triage nurse will co ordinate with the various departments for the

availability of equipments, facilities and resources.

2. The triage nurse will supervise the transportation of the patients, their safety.
3. The CMO billing will counsel the patient's relatives so that there is no panicky situation.

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